

9.9 Service Packs

About once a year, Microsoft releases an update to Windows XP. These updates contain all the fixes and enhancements which have been made available in the previous year. The updates (called Service Packs) provide convenient, all-in-one access to the most up-to-date drivers, tools, security updates, patches, and customer-requested product changes.

The latest Service Pack for Windows XP—Service Pack 2—is all about security, and it's one of the most important service packs ever released. It provides better protection against viruses, hackers, and worms, and includes Windows Firewall, Pop-up Blocker for Internet Explorer, and the new Windows Security Center.

The official page for Windows XP SP2 (Service Pack 2) is www.microsoft.com/windowsxp/sp2/default.mspx

To download SP2 from Microsoft Update, point your browser to <http://go.microsoft.com/?linkid=3646727>

9.9.1 Why SP2?

Here are Microsoft's top 10 reasons to install SP2.

1. Help protect your PC from harmful attachments.

By alerting you to potentially unsafe attachments, SP2 helps guard your computer from viruses that can spread through Internet Explorer, Outlook Express, and Windows Messenger.

2. Improve your privacy when you're on the Web.

SP2 helps protect your private information by applying the security settings that guard your PC to the files and content downloaded using Internet Explorer.

3. Avoid potentially unsafe downloads.

Internet Explorer download monitoring and the Internet Explorer Information Bar warn you about potentially harmful downloads and give you the option to block files that could be malicious.